

# **General Knowledge**

## **Art & Culture**

### **STUDY NOTES**

#### **Fairs and Festivals**





## FAIRS AND FESTIVALS



India is known for its vibrant and diverse culture, which is reflected in its numerous fairs and festivals. These events celebrate the country's traditions, religions, harvests, and historical moments, fostering unity and joy. Below are categorized notes on important festivals across various regions and religions.

### Fairs in India



## Important Fairs and Melas in India

| Fair/Mela Name                    | State           | Month            | Features                                                |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ambubachi Mela</b>             | Assam           | June             | Celebrates fertility goddess at Kamakhya Temple         |
| <b>Baneshwar Fair</b>             | Rajasthan       | January-February | Tribal fair at Mahadev Temple, Dungarpur                |
| <b>Chandrabahaga Fair</b>         | Rajasthan       | February         | Held on Kartik Purnima near Chandrabhaga River          |
| <b>Gangasagar Fair</b>            | West Bengal     | January          | Pilgrimage at the confluence of Ganga and Bay of Bengal |
| <b>Madhavpur Mela</b>             | Gujarat         | April            | Celebrates Krishna's marriage with Rukmini              |
| <b>Medaram Jatara</b>             | Telangana       | January-February | Honors tribal deities Sammakka and Saramma              |
| <b>Surajkund Handicrafts Mela</b> | Haryana         | February         | Promotes handicrafts and folk traditions                |
| <b>Pushkar Fair</b>               | Rajasthan       | November         | Camel fair and pilgrimage near Pushkar Lake             |
| <b>Sonepur Cattle Fair</b>        | Bihar           | November         | Asia's largest cattle fair at Sonepur                   |
| <b>Hemis Festival</b>             | Ladakh          | June-July        | Celebrated at Hemis Monastery with traditional dances   |
| <b>Kumbh Mela</b>                 | Multiple States | Every 12 years   | Largest religious gathering at four locations           |
| <b>Nauchandi Fair</b>             | Uttar Pradesh   | March-April      | Cultural and religious fair in Meerut                   |

|                                  |                  |                   |                                                  |
|----------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nagaur Cattle Fair</b>        | Rajasthan        | January-February  | Cattle trading and folk performances             |
| <b>Mewar Fair</b>                | Rajasthan        | March-April       | Celebrates spring with processions and music     |
| <b>Sikar Camel Festival</b>      | Rajasthan        | November-December | Camel races and cultural events                  |
| <b>Bhavnath Fair</b>             | Gujarat          | February          | Held at Bhavnath Mahadev Temple                  |
| <b>Ramnagar Ramlila</b>          | Uttar Pradesh    | September-October | 31-day enactment of the Ramayana                 |
| <b>Ganga Mahotsav</b>            | Uttar Pradesh    | November          | Cultural event on the banks of the Ganga         |
| <b>Char Dham Yatra</b>           | Uttarakhand      | April-October     | Pilgrimage to four sacred sites in the Himalayas |
| <b>Mukteshwar Dance Festival</b> | Odisha           | January           | Classical dance at Mukteshwar Temple             |
| <b>Parab Tribal Festival</b>     | Odisha           | November          | Tribal fair showcasing traditions                |
| <b>Teej Fair</b>                 | Rajasthan        | July-August       | Traditional fair celebrating Teej                |
| <b>Chithirai Mela</b>            | Tamil Nadu       | April-May         | Celebrates celestial wedding in Madurai          |
| <b>Hornbill Festival</b>         | Nagaland         | December          | Cultural fair of Naga tribes                     |
| <b>Kullu Dussehra Fair</b>       | Himachal Pradesh | October           | Cultural fair during Dussehra celebrations       |
| <b>Shimla Summer Festival</b>    | Himachal Pradesh | June              | Celebrates arrival of summer                     |

|                                     |                |                  |                                            |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nehru Trophy Boat Race</b>       | Kerala         | August           | Boat race on Punnamada Lake                |
| <b>Mahabalipuram Dance Festival</b> | Tamil Nadu     | December-January | Classical dance performances               |
| <b>Velankanni Church Festival</b>   | Tamil Nadu     | August-September | Pilgrimage to Velankanni Church            |
| <b>Brahmotsavam Mela</b>            | Andhra Pradesh | September        | Grand fair at Tirupati Temple              |
| <b>Rath Yatra</b>                   | Odisha         | June-July        | Procession of Lord Jagannath's chariot     |
| <b>Wangala Mela</b>                 | Meghalaya      | November         | Garo tribe's harvest festival              |
| <b>Sao Joao Festival</b>            | Goa            | June             | Water sports and cultural events           |
| <b>Surat Diamond Fair</b>           | Gujarat        | December         | Promotes diamond industry                  |
| <b>Chhattisgarh Rajyotsav Mela</b>  | Chhattisgarh   | November         | Showcases local crafts and traditions      |
| <b>Dandari Mela</b>                 | Telangana      | November         | Tribal cultural fair                       |
| <b>Bundi Utsav</b>                  | Rajasthan      | November         | Traditional fair with folk music and dance |
| <b>Tarnetar Fair</b>                | Gujarat        | August-September | Matchmaking fair for tribal communities    |
| <b>Jaipur Literature Festival</b>   | Rajasthan      | January          | World's largest free literary festival     |
| <b>Bikaner Camel Festival</b>       | Rajasthan      | January          | Camel performances and folk dances         |



|                                 |                |                    |                                                       |
|---------------------------------|----------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kite Festival</b>            | Gujarat        | January            | Makar Sankranti celebration with kite flying          |
| <b>Pushkar Camel Fair</b>       | Rajasthan      | November           | Largest camel trading fair in India                   |
| <b>Mysuru Dasara Exhibition</b> | Karnataka      | September-Oct ober | Cultural fair during Dasara celebrations              |
| <b>Kartik Mela</b>              | Uttar Pradesh  | November           | Held in Varanasi on Kartik Purnima                    |
| <b>Desert Festival</b>          | Rajasthan      | February           | Cultural events in the Thar Desert                    |
| <b>Lokrang Mela</b>             | Madhya Pradesh | January            | Folk art and cultural performances                    |
| <b>Hampi Utsav</b>              | Karnataka      | November           | Celebrates the heritage of Hampi with music and dance |
| <b>Suraajkund Mela</b>          | Haryana        | February           | Handicrafts fair promoting artisans                   |
| <b>Vautha Fair</b>              | Gujarat        | November           | Animal trading fair near Sabarmati River              |
| <b>Adoor Gajamela</b>           | Kerala         | February-March     | Elephant procession and temple fair                   |

## Festivals in India



## New Year Festivals in India

| Festival Name | State                                | Month       | Features                                                                                                   |
|---------------|--------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ugadi         | Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana | March-April | Marks the beginning of the Hindu calendar year; celebrated with special dishes like <b>Ugadi Pachadi</b> . |
| Gudi Padwa    | Maharashtra                          | March-April | Celebrate the Maharashtrian New Year with processions and hoisting of Gudi (flag).                         |
| Vishu         | Kerala                               | April       | Celebrate New Year with Vishu Kani (auspicious objects) and feasts.                                        |

|                                  |                  |                  |                                                                             |
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| <b>Baisakhi</b>                  | Punjab           | April            | Marks the Punjabi New Year and the harvesting of rabi crops.                |
| <b>Cheti Chand</b>               | Sindhi Community | March-April      | Sindhi New Year is celebrated with prayers to Lord Jhulelal.                |
| <b>Pohela Boishakh</b>           | West Bengal      | April            | Bengali New Year is celebrated with cultural programs and feasts.           |
| <b>Puthandu</b>                  | Tamil Nadu       | April            | Tamil New Year is celebrated with traditional dishes and house decorations. |
| <b>Losoong</b>                   | Sikkim           | December         | Sikkimese New Year is marked by Buddhist rituals and dances.                |
| <b>Navreh</b>                    | Kashmir          | March-April      | Kashmiri New Year is observed with prayers and family gatherings.           |
| <b>Chaitra Sukhladi</b>          | North India      | March-April      | The Hindu New Year is celebrated with rituals and prayers.                  |
| <b>Bohag Bihu (Rongali Bihu)</b> | Assam            | April            | Assamese New Year and Spring Festival with dance and music.                 |
| <b>Pana Sankranti</b>            | Odisha           | April            | Celebrated as the Odia New Year with rituals and special drinks.            |
| <b>Bestu Varas</b>               | Gujarat          | October-November | Gujarati New Year is celebrated a day after Diwali with prayers and feasts. |
| <b>Mesha Sankranti</b>           | Multiple States  | April            | Solar New Year is observed across India.                                    |
| <b>Chaitti</b>                   | Himachal Pradesh | March-April      | The local New Year festival is celebrated with fairs and gatherings.        |



## Harvest Festivals in India

| Festival Name               | State             | Month            | Features                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Makar Sankranti</b>      | Multiple States   | January          | Celebrates the sun's transition into Capricorn with kite flying and rituals. |
| <b>Pongal</b>               | Tamil Nadu        | January          | Four-day harvest festival thanking the Sun God and cattle.                   |
| <b>Lohri</b>                | Punjab, Haryana   | January          | Bonfires are lit to celebrate the end of winter and harvest season.          |
| <b>Bihu (Rongali Bihu)</b>  | Assam             | April            | Spring festival celebrating the Assamese New Year and sowing season.         |
| <b>Baisakhi</b>             | Punjab            | April            | Celebrates the harvesting of rabi crops and marks the Sikh New Year.         |
| <b>Onam</b>                 | Kerala            | August-September | Commemorates King Mahabali's return with floral decorations and boat races.  |
| <b>Nuakhai</b>              | Odisha            | August-September | Welcomes the new rice crop with family feasts and rituals.                   |
| <b>Wangala Festival</b>     | Meghalaya         | November         | Harvest festival of the Garo tribe with drums and dances.                    |
| <b>Gudi Padwa</b>           | Maharashtra       | March-April      | Celebrate the harvest and New Year with traditional sweets.                  |
| <b>Bhogali Bihu</b>         | Assam             | January          | Harvest festival marking the end of harvesting season.                       |
| <b>Kuttumvanta Festival</b> | Arunachal Pradesh | November         | Celebrates harvest with traditional folk performances.                       |

|                                 |                           |                  |                                                                                        |
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| <b>Ugadi</b>                    | Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka | March-April      | The New Year festival also celebrates the harvest.                                     |
| <b>Mysuru Kaveri Sankramana</b> | Karnataka                 | October          | Marks the onset of the harvest season along the Kaveri River.                          |
| <b>Chhath Puja</b>              | Bihar, Uttar Pradesh      | October-November | Worships the Sun God, thanking him for sustaining life and agriculture.                |
| <b>Sitalsasthi</b>              | Odisha                    | June             | Festival celebrating the marriage of Shiva and Parvati, linked to the monsoon arrival. |
| <b>Phool Dei</b>                | Uttarakhand               | March-April      | Seasonal harvest festival welcoming spring.                                            |
| <b>Agera Festival</b>           | Maharashtra               | September        | Celebrates the harvest season among Mumbai's East Indian community.                    |
| <b>Pana Sankranti</b>           | Odisha                    | April            | Odia New Year and harvest celebration with sweet drinks.                               |
| <b>Mopin Festival</b>           | Arunachal Pradesh         | April            | Harvest festival with local rituals and rice beer celebrations.                        |
| <b>Dree Festival</b>            | Arunachal Pradesh         | July             | Apatani tribe's agricultural festival.                                                 |

## Religious Festivals in India

| Festival Name | Religion | Month            | Features                                                      |
|---------------|----------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Diwali</b> | Hinduism | October-November | Festival of lights celebrating Lord Rama's return to Ayodhya. |

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| <b>Holi</b>               | Hinduism     | March                  | The festival of colours symbolises the triumph of good over evil.         |
| <b>Eid-ul-Fitr</b>        | Islam        | Varies (after Ramadan) | Celebrates the end of fasting with prayers and feasts.                    |
| <b>Eid-ul-Adha</b>        | Islam        | Varies (Dhu al-Hijjah) | Known as Bakrid, commemorates Ibrahim's willingness to sacrifice his son. |
| <b>Christmas</b>          | Christianity | December 25            | The birth of Jesus Christ is celebrated with prayers and festivities.     |
| <b>Easter</b>             | Christianity | March-April            | Celebrate the resurrection of Jesus Christ.                               |
| <b>Guru Nanak Jayanti</b> | Sikhism      | November               | Birth anniversary of Guru Nanak Dev Ji.                                   |
| <b>Vaisakhi</b>           | Sikhism      | April                  | Harvest and religious festival marking the formation of Khalsa.           |
| <b>Buddha Purnima</b>     | Buddhism     | April-May              | The birth, enlightenment, and death of Buddha were celebrated.            |
| <b>Mahavir Jayanti</b>    | Jainism      | March-April            | Birth of Lord Mahavir, the last Jain Tirthankara.                         |
| <b>Ganesh Chaturthi</b>   | Hinduism     | August-September       | Birth of Lord Ganesha with processions and idol immersions.               |
| <b>Navratri</b>           | Hinduism     | September-October      | Nine days of fasting and worship of Goddess Durga.                        |
| <b>Kumbh Mela</b>         | Hinduism     | Every 12 years         | Largest pilgrimage gathering at four holy sites.                          |
| <b>Rath Yatra</b>         | Hinduism     | June-July              | Procession of Lord Jagannath's chariot in Puri.                           |



## Table of Tribal Festivals in India

| Festival Name                    | Tribe/Community | State                   | Month            | Features                                                 |
|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hornbill Festival</b>         | Naga Tribes     | Nagaland                | December         | Celebrates Naga heritage with dances, music, and crafts. |
| <b>Wangala Festival</b>          | Garo Tribe      | Meghalaya               | November         | Post-harvest festival with drum performances.            |
| <b>Dree Festival</b>             | Apatani Tribe   | Arunachal Pradesh       | July             | Agricultural festival with rituals and prayers.          |
| <b>Mopin Festival</b>            | Galo Tribe      | Arunachal Pradesh       | April            | Harvest festival with folk performances and rice beer.   |
| <b>Sammakka-Saralamma Jatara</b> | Koya Tribe      | Telangana               | January-February | Tribal fair honoring deities Sammakka and Saralamma.     |
| <b>Karam Festival</b>            | Oraon Tribe     | Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh | August-September | Worship of the Karam tree for agricultural prosperity.   |
| <b>Bhagoria Festival</b>         | Bhil Tribe      | Madhya Pradesh          | March            | The tribal festival is known for matchmaking traditions. |
| <b>Chhattisgarh Rajyotsav</b>    | Multiple Tribes | Chhattisgarh            | November         | Showcases tribal arts, crafts, and culture.              |

|                       |               |        |          |                                             |
|-----------------------|---------------|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Parab Festival</b> | Odisha Tribes | Odisha | November | Displays tribal traditions and folk dances. |
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### Table of Cultural and Regional Festivals in India

| Festival Name       | Region/State | Month             | Features                                                                       |
|---------------------|--------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Durga Puja</b>   | West Bengal  | September-October | Celebrates Goddess Durga's victory over Mahishasura.                           |
| <b>Pongal</b>       | Tamil Nadu   | January           | Thanksgiving harvest festival for the Sun God.                                 |
| <b>Baisakhi</b>     | Punjab       | April             | Celebrate the harvest and Sikh New Year.                                       |
| <b>Onam</b>         | Kerala       | August-September  | Marks the homecoming of King Mahabali with boat races and floral arrangements. |
| <b>Gudi Padwa</b>   | Maharashtra  | March-April       | Maharashtrian New Year is celebrated with feasts.                              |
| <b>Losoong</b>      | Sikkim       | December          | Sikkimese New Year is marked by traditional dances.                            |
| <b>Goa Carnival</b> | Goa          | February          | Pre-Lenten festival with parades and music.                                    |

|                                   |           |         |                                                |
|-----------------------------------|-----------|---------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Jaipur Literature Festival</b> | Rajasthan | January | Global gathering of authors and intellectuals. |
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## Table of Seasonal Festivals in India

| Festival Name          | Season           | State/Region    | Month                   | Features                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Makar Sankranti</b> | Winter           | Multiple States | January                 | Kite flying marks the transition of the sun into Capricorn. |
| <b>Holi</b>            | Spring           | Multiple States | March                   | Celebrated with colours to mark the arrival of spring.      |
| <b>Basant Panchami</b> | Spring           | North India     | January-February        | Worship of Goddess Saraswati to mark the start of spring.   |
| <b>Onam</b>            | Monsoon          | Kerala          | August-September        | Commemorates King Mahabali with boat races.                 |
| <b>Lohri</b>           | Winter           | Punjab          | January                 | Celebrate the end of winter with bonfires.                  |
| <b>Bihu</b>            | Multiple Seasons | Assam           | January, April, October | Celebrates harvest and Assamese New Year.                   |
| <b>Phool Dei</b>       | Spring           | Uttarakhand     | March-April             | Celebrate nature and fertility with flowers.                |

## National Festivals in India

| Festival Name           | Date          | Features                                                                       |
|-------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Republic Day</b>     | 26th January  | Marks the adoption of the Indian Constitution with parades in New Delhi.       |
| <b>Independence Day</b> | 15th August   | Celebrates India's freedom from British rule with flag-hoisting ceremonies.    |
| <b>Gandhi Jayanti</b>   | 2nd October   | The birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi is celebrated with prayers and homage. |
| <b>Children's Day</b>   | 14th November | Celebrate the birth anniversary of Jawaharlal Nehru.                           |
| <b>Teachers' Day</b>    | 5th September | Honours educators on Dr S. Radhakrishnan's birth anniversary.                  |